The National Theatre of Scotland presents

The Reason I Jump

based on the book by **Naoki Higoshida**, translated by **David Mitchell** and **Keiko Yoshida**
Production conceived and directed by **Graham Eatough**, designed by **Observatorium**, dramaturgy by **Clare Duffy**, choreography by **Zoe Halliday.**

Performers include **Michael Dawson**, **Calum MacRitchie, Emma McCaffrey** and **Nicola Tuxworth**.
An outdoor site-specific performance at The Children's Wood and North Kelvin Meadow, Glasgow in June 2018.

Leading Scottish artist and theatre-maker **Graham Eatough** directs and adapts *The Reason I Jump*, a new project exploring the realities and experience of living with autism. Inspired by the bestselling Naoki Higoshida book of the same name, translated into English by Keiko Yoshida and Cloud Atlas-author David Mitchell in 2013, the piece will take the form of a unique site-specific installation by Observatorium in the Children's Wood and North Kelvin Meadow in the summer of 2018.

Originally written when the author was just thirteen years old, *The Reason I Jump* chronicled Higoshida's experience of his severe autistic spectrum disorder by answering questions that were often levelled at him. After its English translation by Yoshida and Mitchell, themselves the parents of an autistic child, the book became an international hit, topping the Sunday Times and New York Times bestseller lists, and was praised for its honest and eye-opening insights into the realities of living with autism.

This adaptation will be a unique blend of site-specific promenade performance and interactive installation. Created with, and performed by, a group of artists with autism ranging from 16 to 60 years old, the piece will see audiences journey through a mysterious and beautiful series of outdoor mazes in order to experience the work.

The mazes will house different scenes, drawn from experiences in the book as well as the personal experiences of the performers themselves. The performance will offer a highly innovative insight into the infinite number of ways human beings experience life and achieve fulfilment. The production will be accessible to both autistic and non-autistic audience members.

The labyrinth structures will be created with artists from Rotterdam-based practice **Observatorium**, who previously collaborated with Eatough on the celebrated international artwork *Nomanslanding*, which was presented at Sydney Harbour, the Ruhrtrienalle, Germany and Tramway, Glasgow. The group specialise in transforming environments and urban areas through eye-catching architecture and open-air sculptures.

The Children's Wood and North Kelvin Meadow is an award-winning community green space in North Glasgow. Regular events are organised by the community on the land, designed to connect children to nature, raise aspirations and bring people together.

Graham Eatough is an award-winning theatre-maker based in Scotland who also works in visual art and film. His work often blurs the boundaries between theatre and art, challenging an audience's perceptions of reality and fiction and their terms of engagement. His previous projects include the celebrated production of Alasdair Gray's *Lanark* at the Edinburgh International Festival in 2015, and *No End to Enderby*, a major commission for Manchester International Festival 2017 with artist Stephen Sutcliffe. His most recent show with the National Theatre of Scotland, *How to Act*, was an award-winning hit at the 2017 Edinburgh Festival Fringe, and tours Scotland in 2018.

The Reason I Jump has its roots in a Scottish government initiative called ***Limitless***, a collaboration between The National Theatre of Scotland, RCS, and the National Autistic Society Scotland which explored the potential of creative arts in engaging and encouraging work by and for autistic children, teenagers, and young adults.